

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

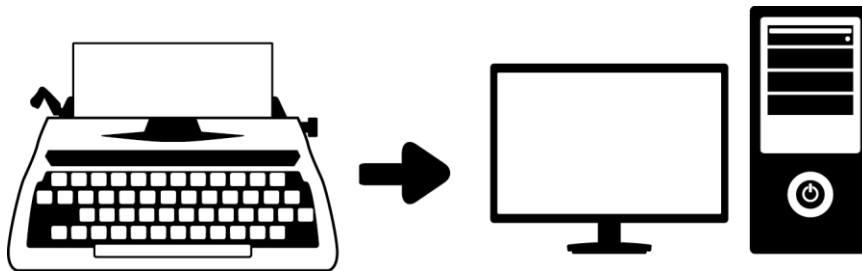
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Let's Start!

The Influence of Information Systems in Business



Learning Outcome:

Identify key information about people's jobs and places of work in spoken or written contexts.

Design the technological architecture of the IT system, through hardware and software recognition, based on available technology in the market, the analysis report and the distribution diagram.

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about the influence of info systems in business.
- I can speculate about how info systems will change business.
- I can describe the importance of info systems in business by giving examples.

Ask your partner:

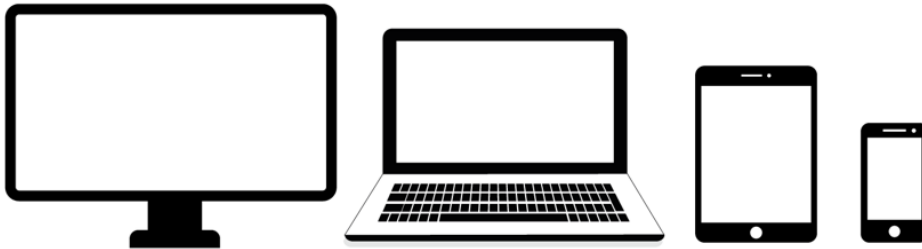
- What business processes does the information system support in the company you work for?
- How do you imagine business transactions will be in 50 years from now?





Let's Explore!

Two senior professionals in IT are talking about the evolution and influence of information systems in the world of business.



Instructions: Read the text below.

- Professional 1:** Do you remember when companies had analog computers, mechanical adding machines and rotary calculators to perform their tasks in the office? Certainly, the IT world has changed substantially since those times, hasn't it?
- Professional 2:** That's true. Though archaic, those machines were the state-of-the-art for information technology purposes. I can say, however, that not all back times were better. With the advent of computers and computer networks, IT has now a great influence worldwide on many important aspects of a business. They're an influence on business strategy, organization culture, organization structure, and management processes. The way people work today and even IT has a huge influence in the workplace.
- Professional 1:** Definitely. In the future, with the new developments in IT, there won't be a project or business operation that can be conducted without the support of information technology. Individuals won't work in isolation any more even living or working in remote places if collaborative work is set. Subscribers to social networks will communicate far more easily in and out of work. Product design and development won't be made anymore without the aid of a design and simulation program connected to a network program to spread the information to different subsidiaries of a company around the world. In conclusion, info systems will bring lots of changes and benefits to the business world.
- Professional 2:** You're totally right, Bryan. The future seems to be very promising indeed. I'd like to say that at present information systems are hugely important for a business. That's why our profession is growing so fast. For example, companies won't be able to deploy a solid business strategy without information systems that help to collect large volumes of data. Then, its analysis followed by collaborative work that allows us to implement several initiatives along with monitoring and assessment tasks.

**Let's Practice!**

Is an information system beneficial?

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to complete each sentence.

Word Bank

be / brings / are / is / bring

1. In the future, there won't _____ any business operation if we don't have the support of information systems.
2. If collaborative work _____ set, people won't work in isolation anymore.
3. If we implement information systems in our business, it will _____ a lot of benefits to us.

**Let's Practice!**

This business will grow fast.

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. I think in the future, there _____ many benefits for our business. (Hint: It will happen.)
 - a. will be
 - b. aren't be
 - c. be
 - d. none of the above
2. Our business _____ very fast because we are implementing information systems. (Hint: Use the base form of the verb after 'will')
 - a. will not grown
 - b. will grow
 - c. growing
 - d. none of the above
3. Subscribers to social networks will _____ far more easily in and out of work. (Hint: Use the base form of the verb.)
 - a. communicate
 - b. communicated
 - c. will communicate
 - d. none of the above
4. Information systems will _____ collect a big amount of data. (Hint: Use the base form of the verb.)
 - a. waits for us
 - b. help us
 - c. helps we
 - d. all of the above





Extension Activity

How will information systems affect my business?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search for information about information systems.
- Identify how information systems affect positively or negatively any business.
- Write down a paragraph explaining future consequences or results of implementing information systems in any business.
- Share your paragraph with your class and discuss about the topic.

Self-Assessment

- | | Yes | No |
|--|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. I search for information about information systems. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 2. I identify how information systems affect any business. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 3. I write down a paragraph explaining future consequences or results of implementing information systems in any business. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 4. I share information and discuss about the topic. | ☐ | ☐ |



Target Words

- **company subsidiary** (noun): a local company that is part of a larger or multinational company
e.g. Product design and development won't be made anymore without the aid of a design and simulation program connected to a network program to spread the information to different subsidiaries of a company around the world.
- **initiative** (noun): a program or project that management has for implementation to achieve the objectives of a company
e.g. Then, its analysis followed by collaborative work that allows us to implement several initiatives along with monitoring and assessment tasks.
- **isolation** (noun): the condition of being apart from others in a far place or with difficult accessibility
e.g. Individuals won't work in isolation any more even living or working in remote places if collaborative work is set.
- **mechanical adding machine** (noun): an invention dated from 1642 to 1970 and used for bookkeeping and numerical calculations in businesses and casinos
e.g. Do you remember when companies had analog computers, mechanical adding machines and rotary calculators to perform their tasks in the office?
- **archaic** (adjective): related to an ancient time in history
e.g. Though archaic, those machines were the state-of-the-art for information technology purposes.
- **management processes** (noun): related to operations done by management such as strategy formulation, capital investment analysis, cost structure analysis, long-term plans, etc.
e.g. They're an influence on business strategy, organization culture, organization structure, and management processes.



Learning Points

First Conditional With the Main Clause in Negative

The First Conditional is about a real condition with a possible consequence or result in the future.

The First Conditional is made of two clauses. The **if** clause expresses the condition, and the **main** clause expresses the possible future result or consequence. It doesn't matter which clause you use first, but in the case you begin with the **if** clause, use a comma to separate both clause.

Look at the examples:

- *If we continue operating with this old-fashioned information technology, we won't be able to reach a competitive level soon.*
- *We won't be able to reach a competitive level soon if we continue operating with this old-fashioned information technology.*

Main Clause in Negative

The main clause, or also called the result clause, can be either positive or negative. The **if** clause can use any of the condition words as seen below:

- Unless (if not)
- So long as
- As soon as (the moment)
- Provided that (on the condition that / only if)
- Whether (if)
- After
- Before
- When

Grammar Structure

The grammatical structure for the first conditional is pretty straightforward.

If clause

If + subject + verb (present simple) + complement,

Main Clause

subject + won't/may not/might not/cannot + complement

Example:

- *If we **replace** timely some old computing equipment, the processes of the business **won't collapse** in the near future.*





Learning Points

Examples

- *Individuals won't work in isolation any more even living or working in remote places if collaborative work is set.*
- *Product design and development won't be made anymore unless the aid of a design and simulation program is connected to a network program to spread the information to different subsidiaries of a company around the world.*

Before Computers

Before computers, many of the tasks we do today were done with other electromechanical machines.

Though limited by the potential for making calculations, for many years mechanical, and later on electromechanical machines, were used for this purpose. They, however, helped to reduce time in such calculations and also gave accuracy when performing tasks that usually fell into the field of bookkeeping and counting. To illustrate this idea, it is necessary to date back to the times of electromechanical adding machines or how about the manual rotary calculator. Not long ago, however, we can recall the use of mechanical typing machines and a rudimentary programmable calculator: the Olivetti Programma 101.

There were other useful machines before computers for handling large amounts of data such as the punched card data processing, which was used for a census in 1890. So when watching TV, you have probably seen those black & white programs in which very old computers were displayed with large tape holders spinning and processing the data contained in a magnet tape. The first computers used analog voltage levels instead of binary numbers, and the measurements taken by them were far from being accurate. By making comparisons of voltage levels, data was collected and therefore databases were created. It was necessary to take several measures to make sure it was correct.

Below, there are some images of some of the machines used before the computer appeared as part of the rudimentary information systems.

Example

- *Do you remember when companies had analog computers, mechanical adding machines and rotary calculators to perform their tasks in the office?*

